

Have a blast of a time, with streams of the entertainment kind

“Streaming is so cool!” exclaims Rajesh Lamba, a cyber cafe owner in Mumbai. “At least five people who come to our cyber cafe love to stream music while they are surfing the Net,” he says. “Just the feeling of listening to music while checking e-mails or surfing is refreshing. And with thousands of sources, you can choose what you want, instead of carrying your own CD. I don’t think many people know about this, otherwise they would be streaming too,” he reckons.

The Internet is changing the way we listen to radio and watch TV. Online radio stations let you choose your listening content while their TV avatars—read streaming video services—let you watch to your taste.

Put on your blue suede shoes

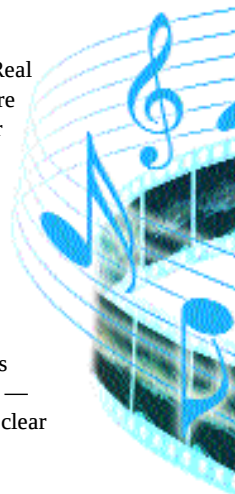
Used mostly for audio and video content, streaming is a technology that sends files in continuous streams, which you can

access without waiting for them to download completely. This lets you play bits and bytes of the file instantly. Obviously, you need an Internet connection that can download streams at about the playback speed.

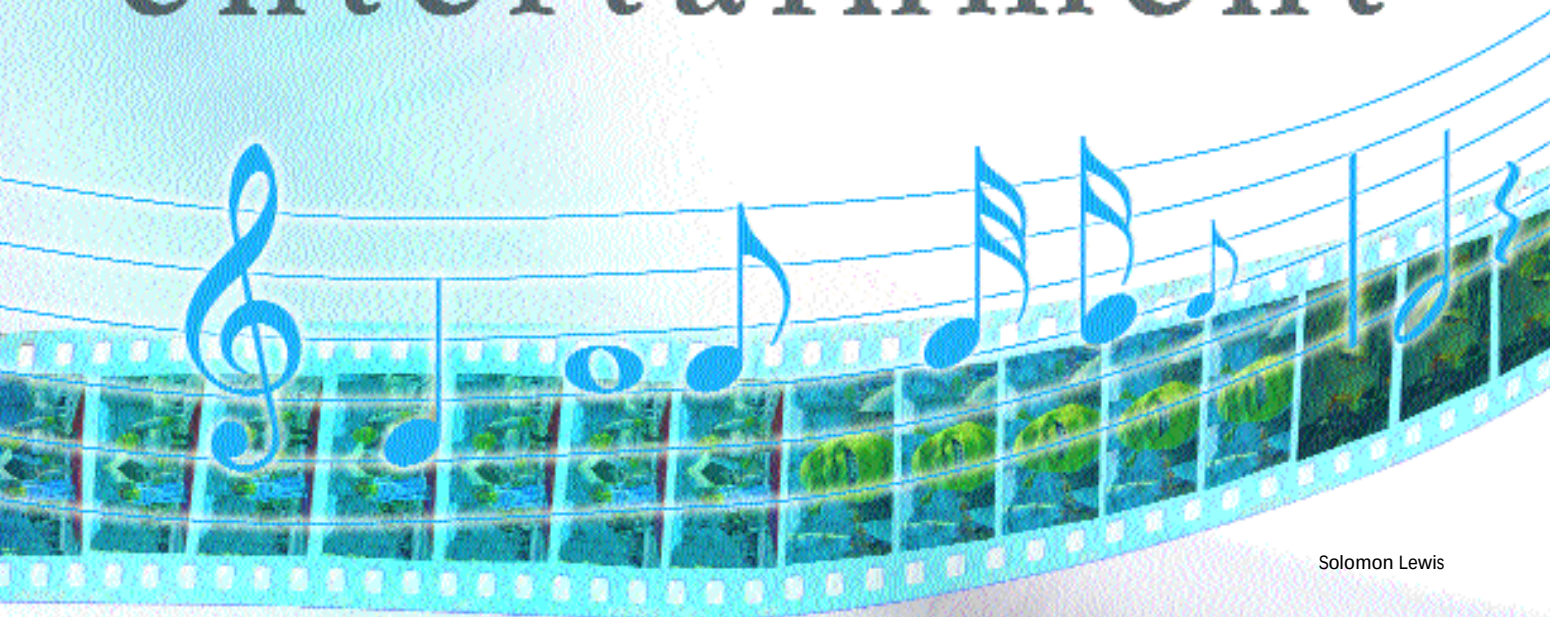
You can find such content on the Web either via the listings in software such as Windows Media Player, or accessing Web sites through a browser.

Play that song

Windows Media Player, Real Player and Winamp are the three most popular streaming media players. Old horse Real Player has come out with a new version that over- sees the streaming process. Real One Player also has a host of radio stations to offer. Winamp 5’s proprietary video format — .nsv—lets you view crystal clear video content.



audio & video entertainment



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